time in the beginning of AD 1674[‡] with the intent to water down the ‘Afridi Revolt’. Aurangzeb had succeeded in convincing the local Pashtun tribes to give away the rebellion intent and join his forces.[§]

Babur’s Narrative Continues

Babur had issued a farman in Kohat which drew the service of a few Afghāns of the Dilazāk and Yūsuf-zāī, Jats and Gujūrs of the region. Accordingly, with their support, he beat the roads, taking a toll with might and main. As soon as he heard about the approach of Bāqī, he blocked the road without making any delay right on time. He made the whole party prisoner and murdered Bāqī and took away his wife. Babur has written in the *Baburnama*, ‘We ourselves had let Bāqī go without injuring him, but his own misdeeds rose up against him; his own acts defeated him.’

Babur composed a couplet as below in the context:[¶]

> Leave thou to Fate the man who does thee wrong;
> For Fate is an avenging servitor.

Babur Attacks the Turkmān Hazāras

That very winter, Babur remained stationed in the Chār-bāgh till it snowed twice at the place. Babur had been facing abundant troubles at the hands of Turkmān Hazāras since the time he had arrived in Kābul. And those insolent acts of them included road robbery as well. Finally, Babur decided to teach them a lesson. He along with his party rode to the house of Aūlūgh Beg Mīrzā’ located at the Būstān-sarāī in February of AD 1506.

And then Babur raided a few Hazāras at the mouth of the Dara-i-khūsh (Happy valley). A few of them were hiding near the mouth of the valley in a cave. Shaikh Darwīsh Kūkūldāsh rushed to the cave without any caution. And to his misfortune, he was shot in the chest by a Hazāra. He succumbed to the shot—there was no way he could have been protected. Then Babur, with all force, marched inside the Dara-i-khūsh, with clear intent to crush them all.

The valley was shut down by a half-a-kilometre gully, which stretched inwards from its orifice. A road encircled the mountain with a straight depreciation of around fifty metre and a cliff above. Horsemen were bound to go around it in a single file. Babur and his party crossed the gully and went on going till around three, post noon without encountering any humans. As the night approached, they found a healthy camel, perhaps belonging to the